



Blink and you'll miss it: The Mackay Test lasted just 750 balls, making it the fourth-shortest completed men's Test and the second-shortest in Australia, putting the pitch firmly under scrutiny. AFP

same when the overseas batters can't play the spinning ball. Then there's no lack of ability but hidden devils in the pitch.

Even today, that brainwashed thinking that a batter has to be judged by how he bats on fast, bouncy pitches prevails, while nobody even asks why lack of footwork, which is such an essential skill requirement to play spin bowling, is not considered a negative and all blame for lack of runs is put

on the surface. Playing spin is a real test of batting skill, as it requires deft footwork and soft hands, while playing fast bowling basically has just two movements, either front foot or back foot. **Yet lots of players with ordinary records in the subcontinent are called great by those from the old powers.** Amazingly, their fast bowlers are never judged by their failure to take wickets on the so-called slow surfaces of the subcontinent. Batters not scoring

runs on fast pitches are not rated, but their fast bowlers not getting wickets on slow surfaces still are called great.

Like I said earlier, the double standards are simply staggering. Let's see what rating the match referee gives the Mackay pitch. But Indian fans, don't hold your breath. The Aussies are breathing comfortably already, knowing there's absolutely nothing for them to worry about.



We all know what really happens. It's just that the Indian management is open about wanting pitches to suit its bowling strength while those from the old powers will do the little whispering and nudging and get a surface that they need.